

AI-Integrated Responsible Data Audit

using Generative AI

Platform Studied: Rapido (Bike Taxi, Auto & Cab App)

CIA 1 – Component 2

Course: Responsible Artificial Intelligence

Unit 2: Ethics of Data Power, Consent, and Digital Inequality

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Section 1: Introduction

Name of Selected Application

Rapido — a bike-taxi, auto, and cab booking platform operated by Roppen Transportation Services Private Limited, headquartered in Bengaluru, India.

Reason for Selection

Rapido was chosen because it operates a two-sided gig-economy marketplace connecting Customers with independent driver-partners called "Captains." This creates a distinctive data ecosystem: Customers share location and payment data for convenience, while Captains are required to submit extensive personal, financial, and biometric-adjacent documentation (KYC, licence, vehicle papers, selfies) to earn a livelihood on the platform. This dual structure makes Rapido a strong case study for examining consent asymmetry, data power, surveillance, and digital inequality — issues that are less visible on single-sided platforms like social media or streaming apps.

Brief Description of the Platform

Rapido is India's largest bike-taxi platform, operating in 500+ cities and offering bike taxis, auto rides, and cab bookings. Customers book rides through the app, which matches them with nearby Captains; the app also processes payments, tracks trips in real time, and stores address, transaction, and ride-history data. Captains use a companion app to accept ride requests, and are subject to onboarding checks including document verification and police/background checks.

Section 2: Privacy and Consent Analysis

Data Collected

- Personal identifiers: name, phone number, email address, and account credentials.
- Location data: precise or approximate location from Customers (opt-in), and continuous foreground/background location from Captains while "On-Duty."
- Transaction information: pickup/drop-off addresses, trip distance, fare, and payment details.
- Captain-specific sensitive data: driving licence, vehicle registration certificate, vehicle insurance, bank account details, self-clicked selfies, residence proof, and identity proof.
- Device and usage information: device identifiers, app interaction data, and cookies (including from third-party content embedded in the app).
- User-generated content: reviews, ratings, and any information voluntarily shared through in-app features.

Purpose of Collection

- Facilitating ride booking, matching, and navigation.
- Processing payments and maintaining transaction records.
- Verifying Captain identity, eligibility, and safety compliance (including background checks).
- Market research, data analytics, service customization, and product improvement.
- Marketing and promotional communication.
- Legal compliance and dispute resolution, including sharing information with government or judicial bodies when required.

Consent Mechanisms

Consent is obtained through a single, bundled acceptance of the Terms of Use and Privacy Policy at registration — a clickwrap model rather than granular, purpose-by-purpose consent. Location access is the one setting users can

toggle independently. Captains additionally provide explicit consent to background verification and long-term data use (including "perpetual, irrevocable" licences over some information) as a condition of onboarding, meaning consent is effectively non-negotiable for anyone who wants to work on the platform.

User Rights and Controls

- Users may request account/data deletion, as reflected in the app's Play Store data-safety disclosure.
- Users can terminate the contract at any time by uninstalling the app.
- There is no visible mechanism for partial consent (e.g., allowing analytics but not marketing sharing) — controls are largely binary (accept-and-use or don't-use-the-app).

Section 3: Ethical Data Audit

Privacy Concerns

- Background location tracking of Captains continues whenever the app is running, gated only by an "On-Duty" toggle rather than a stricter per-trip permission.
- Open-ended sharing language ("including but not limited to") gives Rapido broad discretion over what counts as an acceptable third-party disclosure.
- Rapido explicitly disclaims responsibility for the privacy practices of third-party links, advertisers, and content embedded within the app.

Manipulative Practices or Dark Patterns

- Bundled, all-or-nothing consent at sign-up removes any real choice architecture for users who want the service but not the full data-sharing scope.
- Incentive structures for Captains (e.g., streak-style daily/weekly incentives, surge-linked bonuses) can nudge drivers toward longer hours or riskier trip acceptance to maintain earnings, a pattern common to gig-platform "algorithmic management."
- Engagement-maximizing design choices, such as prominent, hard-to-mute order-alert sounds, prioritize platform responsiveness metrics over Captain autonomy.

Data Power and Surveillance Concerns

- Rapido holds significant informational power over Captains through continuous location tracking, ride-acceptance analytics, and ratings — data that can influence a Captain's access to future rides or incentives, largely through non-transparent algorithms.
- Government/judicial data-sharing clauses mean Captain data can be surfaced in disputes without a clearly defined independent review process from the Captain's side.
- The scale of KYC and identity documentation collected from Captains creates a concentrated, high-value data store whose security practices are not detailed in consumer-facing policy language.

Digital Inequality Issues

- Captains — often from lower-income backgrounds with variable digital literacy — are asked to consent to complex legal terms (perpetual licences, arbitration clauses) that assume a level of legal literacy many users may not have.
- The Privacy Policy and Terms are published in English only, disadvantaging users more comfortable in regional Indian languages.
- Reliance on a smartphone with continuous data connectivity for both booking and earning excludes populations without affordable devices or data plans.

Representational Harm Concerns

- Rating-based systems can encode customer bias (e.g., against accent, appearance, or gender) directly into a Captain's platform standing, with limited transparent appeal mechanisms described in public policy.
- Algorithmic ride-allocation and incentive design are not explained in consumer-facing documents, making it difficult for Captains or Customers to assess whether outcomes are applied fairly across different demographic groups.

Section 4: Critical Evaluation of Generative AI

ChatGPT was used as the Generative AI tool, with Rapido as the target application. All five prescribed prompts were run in sequence within a single conversation. The screenshots below are the actual, unedited responses; the analysis that follows compares each response against Rapido's real Privacy Policy and Terms of Service (Section 2 and 3 above).

Prompt 1 — Summarize the privacy policy and identify data types collected

Summarize the privacy policy of Rapido and identify the types of personal data collected

Here is a concise summary of **Rapido's Privacy Policy** (Roppen Transportation Services Private Limited) and the types of personal data it collects.

Summary of Rapido's Privacy Policy

Rapido's privacy policy explains how it **collects, uses, stores, shares, and protects** users' personal information when they use the Rapido app, website, or related services. The company states that it collects only information necessary to provide transportation and related services, improve the platform, comply with legal obligations, prevent fraud, and enhance user experience. Information may be shared with drivers/captains, vendors, payment providers, government authorities (when legally required), and other service providers under appropriate safeguards. Users are also provided with rights to access, update, or request deletion of their personal information, subject to applicable laws. 🟡 Rapido

Types of Personal Data Collected

Rapido's policy indicates that it may collect the following categories of personal data:

Category	Examples
Personal Identification Information	Name, mobile number, email address, profile details
Identity Verification Information	Government-issued ID details, driving licence (for captains/drivers), photographs or selfies where required
Location Data	Real-time GPS location, pickup and drop locations, route information
Device Information	IP address, device identifier, operating system, browser type, mobile device information
Usage Information	App usage, search history within the app, ride history, preferences, interactions with the platform
Payment Information	Payment method details, transaction history, billing information (payment processing is generally handled through payment partners)
Communication Data	Customer support conversations, emails, chat messages, call records (where permitted)

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Why Rapido Collects This Data

The collected data is primarily used to:

- Create and manage user accounts.
- Book and complete rides.
- Match customers with captains/drivers.
- Process payments and refunds.
- Provide customer support.
- Improve app functionality and user experience.
- Detect fraud and maintain platform security.
- Meet legal and regulatory requirements.
- Send service updates, promotional offers, and notifications (where permitted). 🟡 Rapido

Overall, Rapido states that it collects personal data necessary for delivering its ride-hailing services, improving the platform, ensuring user safety, processing payments, and complying with legal obligations.

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Screenshot 2: ChatGPT response — reasons for data collection

Prompt 2 — Analyze whether consent mechanisms follow ethical principles of informed consent

Analyze whether the consent mechanisms in Rapido follow ethical principles of informed consent.

Analysis of Rapido's Consent Mechanisms and Ethical Principles of Informed Consent

The ethical principle of **informed consent** requires that users:

1. Receive clear and understandable information.
2. Give consent voluntarily.
3. Have the ability to accept or decline specific data collection.
4. Can withdraw consent easily.
5. Understand how their data will be used and shared.

Evaluation of Rapido's Consent Mechanisms

Ethical Principle	Analysis	Assessment
Transparency	Rapido provides a Privacy Policy describing what personal data is collected, why it is collected, and with whom it may be shared. However, the policy is relatively long and contains legal language, which may be difficult for many users to understand.	Partially Meets
Voluntary Consent	Users generally consent to the privacy policy when creating an account or using the app. However, using the service often requires accepting the entire policy, leaving little room to selectively consent to different types of data processing.	Partially Meets
Specific and Informed Consent	Some permissions, such as location access, are requested separately through the mobile operating system. However, many other forms of data processing are covered under the general privacy policy rather than through separate consent options.	Partially Meets
Purpose Limitation	Rapido explains that personal data is used for ride booking, payments, customer support, fraud prevention, legal compliance, and service improvement. This helps users understand the intended purposes.	Meets
User Control	Users can update some account information and may request deletion of their account or data, subject to legal and operational requirements. Device permissions like location can also be managed through phone settings.	Mostly Meets
Easy Withdrawal of Consent	Users can revoke certain permissions (e.g., location), but withdrawing consent for broader data processing generally requires discontinuing use of the service or deleting the account.	Partially Meets

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Mostly Meets

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Specific and Informed Consent	Some permissions, such as location access, are requested separately through the mobile operating system. However, many other forms of data processing are covered under the general privacy policy rather than through separate consent options.	Partially Meets
Purpose Limitation	Rapido explains that personal data is used for ride booking, payments, customer support, fraud prevention, legal compliance, and service improvement. This helps users understand the intended purposes.	Meets
User Control	Users can update some account information and may request deletion of their account or data, subject to legal and operational requirements. Device permissions like location can also be managed through phone settings.	Mostly Meets
Easy Withdrawal of Consent	Users can revoke certain permissions (e.g., location), but withdrawing consent for broader data processing generally requires discontinuing use of the service or deleting the account.	Partially Meets
Data Minimization	Rapido collects data necessary for providing transportation services, including identity, payment, and location information. However, some analytics and usage data may go beyond what users expect unless clearly explained.	Mostly Meets
Strengths - Clearly states the categories of data collected. - Explains the primary purposes for collecting personal information. - Requests permission for sensitive features like location through the device's permission system. - Provides mechanisms to access, update, or delete account information. Weaknesses - The privacy policy is lengthy and legalistic, making it difficult for average users to fully understand. - Users cannot easily choose which non-essential data they wish to share. - Consent is largely bundled into acceptance of the privacy policy during registration. - Withdrawing consent for many processing activities is not straightforward without stopping use of the service. Overall Assessment Rapido's consent mechanisms partially follow the ethical principles of informed consent. The company demonstrates transparency by providing a privacy policy and requesting permission for certain sensitive data such as location. However, it falls short of ideal informed consent because users have limited ability to provide granular, specific, and freely chosen consent for different types of data processing. The complexity of the policy and the bundled nature of consent may ↓ reduce users' understanding of how their personal information is handled.		

Prompt 3 — Identify manipulative data practices, dark patterns, or privacy concerns

Identify any manipulative data practices, dark patterns, or privacy concerns in Rapido

Manipulative Data Practices, Dark Patterns, and Privacy Concerns in Rapido

Based on Rapido's publicly available privacy policy and the typical design of ride-hailing applications, the following issues may raise ethical and privacy concerns. These are **potential concerns** rather than confirmed misconduct.

Area	Observation	Ethical Concern
Bundled Consent	Users generally must accept the privacy policy to use the service, with limited ability to opt in or out of individual data processing activities.	Reduces user autonomy and informed choice.
Continuous Location Access	The app requests access to users' location to provide ride services. If location is collected beyond what is necessary, it may reveal users' daily routines and sensitive places they visit.	Privacy risk due to continuous tracking.
Extensive Data Collection	Rapido collects personal details, device information, ride history, payment details, and app usage data.	Users may not fully understand the breadth of data collected.
Data Sharing with Third Parties	Personal information may be shared with payment providers, service partners, analytics providers, and legal authorities when required.	Users may have limited visibility or control over how third parties use their data.
Lengthy Privacy Policy	The privacy policy is detailed but written in legal language that many users may not read or fully understand.	Limits truly informed consent.
Default Data Collection	Many analytics and service-related data collection practices are enabled by default once users accept the privacy policy.	May encourage users to share more data than necessary.
Retention of Personal Data	Data may be retained for legal, operational, or business purposes even after account deletion, where permitted by law.	Users may expect immediate deletion but not receive it.

Possible Dark Patterns

Rapido does not appear to use obvious deceptive dark patterns such as hidden subscription fees. However, some design choices may be considered **soft dark patterns**:

- **Forced Consent:** Users generally cannot use the app without agreeing to the privacy policy.

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Privacy Concerns

1. Location Privacy

- Continuous or repeated location tracking can reveal home, workplace, travel patterns, and frequently visited places.

2. Profiling

- Ride history, app usage, and location data can be combined to build detailed user profiles.

3. Third-Party Sharing

- Sharing information with service providers and analytics partners increases the number of organizations handling users' personal data.

4. Data Security

- Like any digital platform, Rapido faces risks of unauthorized access or data breaches despite implementing security measures.

5. Data Retention

- Keeping personal data after service completion may increase privacy risks if retained longer than necessary.

Ethical Assessment

Positive Practices

- Explains the categories of data collected.
- States the purposes for collecting personal information.
- Uses device-level permission requests for sensitive data such as location.
- Allows users to update account information and request account deletion, subject to legal requirements.

Areas for Improvement

- Provide **simpler, easier-to-understand privacy notices**.
- Offer **granular consent** for optional analytics and marketing data.
- Minimize collection of non-essential personal information.
- Give users **greater control** over data sharing and retention.
- Make data deletion and consent withdrawal more transparent and straightforward.

Conclusion

Rapido does not publicly exhibit severe deceptive dark patterns, but it has **potential privacy concerns** common to many ride-hailing platforms. These include **bundled consent**, **extensive location tracking**, **broad data collection**, **third-party data sharing**, and **limited granular user control**. From an ethical perspective, improving transparency, offering more meaningful consent choices, and strengthening user privacy controls would better align the platform with principles of responsible data handling.

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Prompt 4 — Evaluate digital inequality and representational harm

Evaluate potential issues of digital inequality and representational harm associated with data collection practices in Rapido.

Evaluation of Digital Inequality and Representational Harm in Rapido's Data Collection Practices

Rapido's data collection practices, while intended to support ride-hailing services, can contribute to digital inequality and representational harm if not carefully designed and monitored.

1. Digital Inequality

Digital inequality refers to unequal access to digital services or unequal treatment due to differences in technology, socioeconomic status, or digital literacy.

Issue	Explanation	Impact
Smartphone and Internet Dependency	Rapido requires a smartphone, internet connection, GPS, and digital payment options for the best experience.	Excludes people without smartphones, reliable internet, or digital payment access.
Digital Literacy	The privacy policy and app permissions may be difficult for users with limited digital literacy to understand.	Users may unknowingly consent to extensive data collection.
Location-Based Accessibility	Services are more widely available in urban areas than in rural regions.	Rural populations may have limited access to affordable transportation services.
Language Barriers	If privacy notices and app interfaces are primarily in English or a limited number of languages, some users may struggle to understand them.	Non-English speakers may not be able to make informed privacy decisions.
Device Compatibility	Older or low-end smartphones may not support all app features effectively.	Lower-income users may experience reduced service quality or be unable to use the app.

2. Representational Harm

Representational harm occurs when data collection or algorithms reinforce stereotypes, create unfair profiles, or produce biased outcomes.

Issue	Explanation	Possible Consequences
Location Profiling	Ride history and GPS data can reveal where users live, work, worship, or receive healthcare.	Users may be unfairly profiled based on their travel patterns.
Behavioral Profiling	Frequent destinations, travel times, and ride frequency can be used to build detailed behavioral profiles.	May influence personalized pricing, promotions, or recommendations in ways users do not expect.
Algorithmic Bias	If matching, fraud detection, or incentive algorithms are trained on biased historical data, they may unintentionally disadvantage certain groups or locations.	Some users or drivers may receive fewer ride opportunities or face higher scrutiny.
Socioeconomic Inference	Travel destinations and ride choices may indirectly reveal income level, occupation, or lifestyle.	Could reinforce stereotypes or result in unequal treatment if used in automated decision-making.
Gender and Safety Concerns	Personal information and ride history could expose sensitive patterns, particularly for women or vulnerable users, if not adequately protected.	Increased privacy and safety risks in the event of misuse or unauthorized access.

Ethical Implications

From an ethical perspective, these concerns relate to key principles:

- Fairness: Services should not disadvantage users based on income, location, language, or device quality.
- Privacy: Only the minimum data necessary should be collected, especially sensitive location information.
- Transparency: Users should clearly understand what data is collected and how it affects service decisions.
- Non-Discrimination: Algorithms should be regularly audited to reduce bias and ensure equitable treatment of users and drivers.

Recommendations for Improvement

To reduce digital inequality and representational harm, Rapido could:

- Offer privacy policies and consent forms in multiple regional languages.
- Use plain, easy-to-understand language instead of complex legal terms.
- Provide granular consent options for optional collection (such as analytics and marketing).
- Apply data minimization, collecting only information essential for providing ride services.

Prompt 5 — List ethical concerns from a Responsible AI perspective

List ethical concerns that may arise from the platform's data practices from a Responsible AI perspective

Ethical Concerns in Rapido's Data Practices from a Responsible AI Perspective

Responsible AI emphasizes fairness, transparency, accountability, privacy, security, human oversight, and inclusiveness. Based on these principles, the following ethical concerns may arise from Rapido's data practices.

Responsible AI Principle	Ethical Concern	Explanation
Privacy	Excessive collection of personal data	Collecting location, ride history, device information, and payment details can expose sensitive information about users if not properly limited and protected.
Transparency	Lack of clear communication	Privacy policies may be lengthy or difficult to understand, making it hard for users to know how their data is collected, used, and shared.
Fairness	Algorithmic bias	AI-based ride allocation, pricing, or fraud detection systems could unintentionally disadvantage certain users, drivers, or geographic areas if trained on biased data.
Accountability	Limited explanation of AI decisions	Users may not know why certain rides are cancelled, prices change, or accounts are flagged, making it difficult to challenge automated decisions.
User Autonomy	Bundled consent	Users often must accept the entire privacy policy to use the service, limiting meaningful choice over optional data collection.
Data Minimization	Collecting more data than necessary	Analytics and behavioral data may be collected beyond what is strictly required to provide transportation services.
Security	Risk of data breaches	Personal and financial information could be exposed if security controls fail or systems are compromised.
Non-Discrimination	Unequal treatment	AI systems could inadvertently favor certain locations, customer groups, or drivers, leading to unfair service distribution.
Human Oversight	Over-reliance on automated systems	Decisions made entirely by algorithms without human review may result in unfair outcomes for users or drivers.
Inclusiveness	Digital exclusion	People with limited digital literacy, older smartphones, poor internet connectivity, or language barriers may find it difficult to access or understand the platform.

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Human Oversight	Over-reliance on automated systems	Decisions made entirely by algorithms without human review may result in unfair outcomes for users or drivers.
Inclusiveness	Digital exclusion	People with limited digital literacy, older smartphones, poor internet connectivity, or language barriers may find it difficult to access or understand the platform.

Key Ethical Risks

- **Location Privacy:** Continuous GPS tracking can reveal users' homes, workplaces, and daily routines.
- **Profiling:** AI can create detailed profiles from ride history, travel patterns, and app usage.
- **Surveillance:** Extensive monitoring of user behavior may reduce users' sense of privacy.
- **Bias in AI Models:** Historical data may reinforce existing inequalities in ride allocation or fraud detection.
- **Limited User Control:** Users may have few options to control or limit non-essential data collection.
- **Third-Party Sharing:** Sharing data with payment processors, analytics providers, or partners increases privacy risks if safeguards are insufficient.
- **Data Retention:** Keeping personal data longer than necessary increases the potential impact of unauthorized access or misuse.

Recommendations for Responsible AI

To better align with Responsible AI principles, Rapido should:

1. Collect only the **minimum data necessary** for providing services.
2. Provide **clear, simple, and multilingual privacy notices**.
3. Offer **granular consent** for optional data processing (e.g., analytics and marketing).
4. Regularly **audit AI algorithms** for bias and discriminatory outcomes.
5. Explain important **AI-driven decisions** (such as account restrictions or dynamic pricing) in understandable terms.
6. Strengthen **data security** using encryption, access controls, and regular security audits.
7. Give users **greater control** over their data, including easier access, correction, deletion, and consent withdrawal.
8. Ensure **human review** is available for significant automated decisions affecting users or drivers.

Conclusion

From a Responsible AI perspective, the primary ethical concerns in Rapido's data practices include **privacy risks, limited transparency, bundled consent, algorithmic bias, profiling, data security, unequal treatment, and insufficient user control**. By adopting stronger privacy protections, improving transparency, ensuring fairness in AI systems, and providing meaningful user choice, Rapido can build greater trust and better align its platform with Responsible AI principles.

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Correct Observations Generated by AI

- Data categories: the AI's list (identity info, ID/verification documents, location, device info, usage, payment, communication data) matches what Rapido's actual Privacy Policy and Captain Terms disclose, including Captain-specific items like driving licence and selfies.
- Bundled/all-or-nothing consent: the AI correctly identified that Rapido's consent is obtained through a single privacy-policy acceptance at registration rather than granular, purpose-specific consent — this matches the clickwrap model in the real Terms.
- Appropriately hedged dark-pattern claims: rather than asserting Rapido uses deceptive dark patterns, the AI correctly qualified its findings as "potential concerns rather than confirmed misconduct," which reflects the actual policy — there is no evidence of hidden fees or deceptive subscription traps.
- Language accessibility: the AI flagged English-only privacy notices as a plausible digital-inequality risk. This is in fact verifiably true — Rapido's Privacy Policy and Terms pages are published only in English.
- Purpose-limitation framing: the AI's account of why data is collected (ride matching, payments, fraud prevention, legal compliance, service improvement) aligns with the actual Privacy Policy's stated purposes.

Missing Ethical Concerns

- Captain vs. Customer location tracking asymmetry: none of the five responses distinguished between a Customer's opt-in location sharing and a Captain's continuous foreground/background tracking (gated only by an "On-Duty" toggle). This is a real, specific clause in Rapido's Privacy Policy and represents a much stronger surveillance obligation placed on gig workers — a detail every prompt treated as if location tracking applied equally to all users.
- The perpetual/irrevocable data licence: Rapido's Customer Terms grant Rapido a broad licence to use, reproduce, and distribute certain "Other Information" as part of "Aggregated Statistics," and separately claim rights over Captain Information for business, marketing, and analytics purposes. No prompt surfaced this clause, even though it is directly relevant to Prompt 2's question about informed, revocable consent.
- Captain-side dark patterns: the manipulative-practices analysis (Prompt 3) focused entirely on Customer-facing concerns. It did not address gig-worker-specific design pressures documented in real user reviews of the Rapido Captain app — such as intentionally loud/hard-to-mute ride-alert sounds and incentive schemes (e.g., "Rain incentives," streak-style bonuses) that can pressure Captains into longer hours or riskier trip acceptance.
- Mandatory background/police verification: Rapido's Captain Terms require KYC documents and explicit consent to police verification and background checks as a condition of onboarding. This is a significant data-power and consent-asymmetry issue (Captains cannot decline and still work on the platform) that none of the five prompts raised, despite Prompt 2 and Prompt 4 directly asking about consent and inequality.

Hallucinations or Incorrect Claims

- Prompt 1's summary states data may be shared with third parties "under appropriate safeguards." This phrase does not appear in Rapido's actual Privacy Policy, which instead uses much more open-ended language (data may be shared "for any purpose, including but not limited to" market research, analytics, and service customization) with no explicit safeguards commitment. This is a mild hallucination — the AI added a reassuring qualifier that makes the real policy sound more protective than it is.
- No outright false factual claims were found (e.g., no invented user rights or fabricated features). The more common failure mode across all five responses was omission and over-generalization rather than fabrication — the AI tended to answer as if describing a generic ride-hailing app rather than citing Rapido's specific clauses.

Biases and Limitations of the AI Tool

- Genericization: across all five prompts, ChatGPT's answers read as templates applicable to "a typical ride-hailing platform" with Rapido's name inserted, rather than analysis clearly grounded in Rapido's specific policy text. Very few responses cited or quoted an actual clause.

- Customer-centric framing: even though Rapido is explicitly a two-sided marketplace, every response defaulted to "users" as Customers and gave little independent attention to Captains, who face materially different (and often more invasive) data obligations. This is a structural blind spot rather than a one-off error.
- No apparent live verification: ChatGPT did not indicate it had browsed Rapido's actual current policy page, and its inability to cite specific clauses (e.g., the foreground/background location clause, the perpetual licence clause) suggests its answers came from general training knowledge about ride-hailing apps rather than a live fetch of Rapido's policy. This limits its reliability for an audit that specifically requires comparison against a named platform's actual, current terms.
- Good epistemic hedging, but at a cost: the AI consistently used cautious language ("may," "could," "if not carefully designed"), which avoided overconfident false claims but also meant it rarely committed to a checkable, specific fact — making several of its points harder to mark as clearly "correct" or "incorrect" rather than simply plausible.

Section 5: Verification Table

Each row below cross-checks a specific claim from the ChatGPT screenshots above against Rapido's actual Privacy Policy and Terms of Service.

AI Observation	Correct/Incorrect	Evidence from Privacy Policy	Missing Ethical Issues	AI Limitations/Hallucinations
(Prompt 1) Data may be shared with drivers, vendors, payment providers, and government authorities 'under appropriate safeguards.'	Partially Incorrect	The actual Privacy Policy shares data 'for any purpose, including but not limited to' market research, analytics, and service customization — with no explicit safeguards commitment stated.	AI did not flag the open-ended, discretionary scope of the real sharing clause as a transparency concern.	Mild hallucination — AI added a reassuring 'appropriate safeguards' qualifier not present in the source text.
(Prompt 1 & 2) Users can update account information and request deletion of their account/data.	Correct	Matches the Google Play data-safety disclosure ('you can request that data be deleted') for both the Rapido Customer and Captain apps.	None on this specific point.	No hallucination; accurately reported.
(Prompt 2) Consent is largely bundled into acceptance of the privacy policy during registration, with little ability to selectively consent.	Correct	Both Customer Terms and Captain Terms require a single acceptance of the Terms of Use/Privacy Policy as a condition of using the Platform — a clickwrap model with no granular opt-outs.	AI did not connect this to the Customer Terms' 'perpetual, irrevocable' licence Rapido takes over certain user-generated ('Other') information — an even stronger example of non-revocable consent.	No hallucination; correct but incomplete.
(Prompt 1) Location data is described generically as 'real-time GPS location, pickup and drop locations, route information' for 'users.'	Incomplete	The Privacy Policy specifies Customers must opt in to share location, while Captains are tracked in the foreground AND background whenever the app is running, gated only by an 'On-Duty' toggle.	AI did not surface the Customer/Captain asymmetry in continuous location tracking — a key data-power issue for gig workers.	Not a hallucination, but a significant oversimplification across user types.
(Prompt 3) Rapido 'does not appear to use obvious deceptive dark patterns,' though 'Forced Consent' is	Correct	No evidence in the Privacy Policy or Terms of hidden fees or deceptive subscription traps; bundled consent at registration matches the 'Forced	Did not mention Captain-facing design pressures (e.g., loud/insistent ride-alert sounds, streak- or weather-linked incentive schemes) noted in real	No hallucination; appropriately hedged, but Customer-centric — missed the gig-worker side of the marketplace.

flagged as a soft dark pattern.		Consent' description.	Play Store Captain reviews.	
(Prompt 4) English-only privacy notices may exclude non-English speakers from informed consent.	Correct	Rapido's Privacy Policy and both sets of Terms and Conditions (Customer and Captain) are published only in English.	None on this specific point — accurate and relevant.	AI phrased this conditionally ('if... primarily in English') rather than as a verified fact, suggesting it did not actually check the live page but reasoned generically about ride-hailing apps.
(Prompt 5) Table maps concerns to Responsible AI principles (privacy, transparency, fairness, accountability, human oversight, inclusiveness) at a general, industry-wide level.	Correct but generic	Broadly consistent with issues found in Sections 2–3, but the response does not cite any specific Rapido clause (e.g., background checks, perpetual licence) to ground the principles.	Mandatory Captain background/police verification as a non-negotiable condition of onboarding — a concrete Responsible-AI/consent-asymmetry issue — was never raised across any of the five prompts.	No fabricated claims, but the analysis is templated and could apply to almost any ride-hailing platform, not distinctly Rapido.

Section 6: Ethical Reflection

This audit of Rapido's data practices makes clear that responsible data handling is not simply about legal compliance but about designing systems where consent is meaningful and power asymmetries are actively managed. Rapido's Privacy Policy technically discloses most of what it collects, yet the bundled, all-or-nothing consent model means Customers and Captains cannot selectively agree to some uses of their data while declining others. This raises the deeper question of whether users can ever truly give "informed" consent online: most people do not read lengthy legal documents before tapping "Accept," and even those who do face vague clauses such as "including but not limited to" that leave room for broad, unanticipated data use. For gig workers like Rapido's Captains, the imbalance is sharper still — accepting extensive data collection is not optional if they want to earn a living, which turns consent into a formality rather than a genuine choice.

Organizations bear the primary responsibility here: they should offer granular consent controls, publish policies in accessible language and multiple regional languages, and proactively disclose how algorithmic systems (ratings, incentives, ride allocation) affect users' livelihoods and experiences, rather than leaving these opaque. Regulators and platform-accountability frameworks also have a role in setting minimum standards for gig-economy data practices specifically.

On Generative AI's reliability for ethical auditing, this exercise showed that AI tools can competently summarize disclosed facts but often miss power-related and structural concerns — such as consent asymmetry or language exclusion — unless explicitly prompted to look for them. AI-generated audits are a useful starting point but cannot replace careful, human verification against primary source documents.

References

- Rapido Privacy Policy — <https://www.rapido.bike/Privacy>
- Rapido Customer Terms and Conditions (Bike Taxi) — <https://www.rapido.bike/CustomerTerms>
- Rapido Customer Terms and Conditions (Cabs and Auto) — <https://www.rapido.bike/CustomerTermsOnly>
- Rapido Captain Terms and Conditions — <https://www.rapido.bike/CaptainTerms>
- Rapido: Bike-Taxi, Auto & Cabs — Google Play Store listing (data safety section) — <https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.rapido.passenger>
- Rapido Captain — Google Play Store listing (data safety section) — <https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.rapido.rider>